

POLITICAL OBLIGATION, RESISTANCE AND LAW

POLITICAL OBLIGATION: PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS → LAW: NATURE, SCHOOLS AND → OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBS → JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE → PUNISHMENT, TRAPS, BOUNDARIES AND → THESES AND DIRECTIVE-SPECIFIC ARCHITECTURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 POLITICAL OBLIGATION: PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS AND GROUNDS

POLITICAL OBLIGATION PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS AND GROUNDS CENTRAL FOCUS [1] POLITICAL OBLIGATION ASKS WHY, WHEN AND HOW FAR [2] FORCE EXPLAINS COMPLIANCE BUT CANNOT BY ITSELF CREATE [3] CONSENT, COMMON GOOD AND RIGHTS SUPPLY RIVAL GROUNDS [4] THE SUBJECT THEREFORE BEGINS BY SEPARATING POWER, AUTHORITY COERCIVE SUCCESS EXPLAINS OBEDIENCE BUT NOT A DUTY TO

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Political Obligation: Problem, Definitions and Grounds
- [1] Political obligation asks why, when and how far authority should be obeyed.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Force explains compliance but cannot by itself create a moral duty.
- [3] Consent, common good and rights supply rival grounds of obligation.
- [4] The subject therefore begins by separating power, authority and justified obedience.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Coercive success explains obedience but not a duty to obey.
- ANSWER USE → Open by separating causal compliance from justified obligation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Coercive success explains obedience but not a duty to obey.

01

STAGE 01 LAW: NATURE, SCHOOLS AND THE RULE-OF-LAW SEQUENCE

NATURE, SCHOOLS AND THE RULE-OF-LAW SEQUENCE CENTRAL FOCUS [1] PRESCRIPTIVE LAW DIRECTS CONDUCT; SCIENTIFIC LAW DESCRIBES REGULARITY. [2] NATURAL, ANALYTICAL, HISTORICAL AND SOCIOLOGICAL SCHOOLS ASK DIFFERENT [3] LEGAL VALIDITY AND MORAL LEGITIMACY CAN DIVERGE WITHOUT [4] RULE OF LAW JOINS KNOWN RULES TO RESTRAINTS LAW MUST BE ANALYSED THROUGH VALIDITY, PURPOSE, HISTORY AND ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS

Law: Nature, Schools and the Rule-of-Law Sequence

[1] Prescriptive law directs conduct; scientific law describes regularity.

[2] Natural, analytical, historical and sociological schools ask different questions.

[3] Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge without making law irrelevant.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Law: Nature, Schools and the Rule-of-Law Sequence
- [1] Prescriptive law directs conduct; scientific law describes regularity.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Natural, analytical, historical and sociological schools ask different questions.
- [3] Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge without making law irrelevant.
- [4] Rule of law joins known rules to restraints on arbitrary public power.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Law must be analysed through validity, purpose, history and restraint.
- ANSWER USE → Name the jurisprudential question before selecting a school.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Law must be analysed through validity, purpose, history and restraint.

02

STAGE 02 OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBS TO GANDHI

OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBS TO GANDHI CENTRAL FOCUS [1] HOBBS PRIORITISES SECURITY; LOCKE TREATS GOVERNMENT AS A [2] ROUSSEAU LINKS OBEDIENCE TO THE GENERAL WILL; GREEN [3] MARXISTS AND ANARCHISTS DENY DUTY TO THE COERCIVE [4] GANDHI AND THOREAU TURN CONSCIENCE INTO DISCIPLINED, PUBLIC GROUNDS OF OBLIGATION PRODUCE DIFFERENT LIMITS ON RESISTANCE. ANSWER USE

Obligation Thinkers from Hobbes to Gandhi

[1] Hobbes prioritises security; Locke treats government as a limited trust.

[2] Rousseau links obedience to the general will; Green limits it by common good.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Obligation Thinkers from Hobbes to Gandhi
- [1] Hobbes prioritises security; Locke treats government as a limited trust.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Rousseau links obedience to the general will; Green limits it by common good.
- [3] Marxists and anarchists deny duty to the coercive state in different ways.
- [4] Gandhi and Thoreau turn conscience into disciplined, public non-compliance.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Grounds of obligation produce different limits on resistance.
- ANSWER USE → Compare security, trust, civic authorship and common good.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Grounds of obligation produce different limits on resistance.

03

STAGE 03 JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE APPLICATION

JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE APPLICATION CENTRAL FOCUS [1] AUSTIN DEFINES LAW THROUGH SOVEREIGN COMMAND AND SANCTION. [2] Kelsen AND HART RECONSTRUCT POSITIVISM THROUGH NORM HIERARCHY [3] DWORKIN IS AN INTERPRETIVIST CRITIC, NOT A FOURTH [4] RESISTANCE, REVOLUTION, OBJECTION AND CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE REMAIN DISTINCT DWORKIN CHALLENGES POSITIVISM RATHER THAN COMPLETING ITS INTERNAL SEQUENCE. ANSWER USE

- [4] Gandhi and Thoreau turn conscience into disciplined, public non-compliance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Grounds of obligation produce different limits on resistance.

STAGE 03 JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE APPLICATION

[3] DWORKIN IS AN INTERPRETIVIST CRITIC, NOT A FOURTH

ANSWER USE

MODEL / STANDARD	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	INSTITUTIONAL LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[2] Kelsen and Hart reconstruct positivism through norm hierarchy and rule structure.	VERDICT → Dworkin challenges positivism rather than completing its internal sequence.
Jurisprudence, Resistance and Comparative Application	[3] Dworkin is an interpretivist critic, not a fourth positivist refinement.	ANSWER USE → Separate Austin, Kelsen, Hart and Dworkin by argumentative role.
[1] Austin defines law through sovereign command and sanction.	[4] Resistance, revolution, objection and civil disobedience remain distinct modes.	

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- [4] Resistance, revolution, objection and civil disobedience remain distinct modes.

- ANSWER USE → Separate Austin, Kelsen, Hart and Dworkin by argumentative role.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Dworkin challenges positivism rather than completing its internal sequence.

STAGE 04 PUNISHMENT, TRAPS, BOUNDARIES AND SOURCE DISCIPLINE

[3] PROPORTIONALITY LIMITS SEVERITY AND PREVENTS PUNISHMENT FROM BECOMING

ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER	POLITICAL MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- CENTRAL FOCUS - Punishment, Traps, Boundaries and Source Discipline [1] Retribution asks what culpable wrongdoing deserves.	[2] Deterrence asks what prevents future crime; reform asks how return is possible. [3] Proportionality limits severity and prevents punishment from becoming revenge. [4] Legal guilt never settles aim, quantum, fallibility or dignity by itself.	- VERDICT → Punishment requires guilt, a justified aim and proportionate severity. - ANSWER USE → Do not infer deterrence or desert merely from a harsh sentence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Punishment requires guilt, a justified aim and proportionate severity.

STAGE 05 THESES AND DIRECTIVE-SPECIFIC ARCHITECTURE

ANSWER USE

- [1] A political-obligation thesis must identify unlimited, limited or anti-obligation.

- [4] A jurisprudence answer must separate positivist reconstruction from Dworkin's critique.

- ANSWER USE → State the obligation camp or jurisprudential dispute in the thesis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Directive fidelity determines the comparison and verdict required.

STAGE 06 AUSTIN, HART AND DWORKIN: ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION

[3] DWORKIN ARGUES THAT LEGAL PRINCIPLES CONSTRAIN HARD CASES

LEGAL SYSTEMS CONTAIN COMMANDS, RULES, PRACTICES AND CONTESTED PRINCIPLES.



06

STAGE 06 AUSTIN, HART AND DWORKIN: ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION

AUSTIN, HART AND DWORKIN ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION CENTRAL FOCUS [1] AUSTIN'S COMMAND MODEL CANNOT EXPLAIN EVERY POWER-CONFERRING LEGAL [2] HART ANSWERS WITH PRIMARY AND SECONDARY RULES GROUNDED [3] DWORKIN ARGUES THAT LEGAL PRINCIPLES CONSTRAIN HARD CASES [4] THE RESIDUAL DISPUTE CONCERNS SOURCES, PRINCIPLES AND JUDICIAL LEGAL SYSTEMS CONTAIN COMMANDS, RULES, PRACTICES AND CONTESTED PRINCIPLES.

CENTRAL FOCUS

Austin, Hart and Dworkin: Argument Reconstruction

[1] Austin's command model cannot explain every power-conferring legal rule.

[2] Hart answers with primary and secondary rules grounded in social practice.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Austin, Hart and Dworkin: Argument Reconstruction
- [1] Austin's command model cannot explain every power-conferring legal rule.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Hart answers with primary and secondary rules grounded in social practice.
- [3] Dworkin argues that legal principles constrain hard cases beyond pedigree tests.
- [4] The residual dispute concerns sources, principles and judicial interpretation.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Legal systems contain commands, rules, practices and contested principles.
- ANSWER USE → Reconstruct each critique before judging the remaining dispute.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Legal systems contain commands, rules, practices and contested principles.

07

STAGE 07 NAMED EVIDENCE FOR OBLIGATION, LAW AND RESISTANCE

NAMED EVIDENCE FOR OBLIGATION, LAW AND RESISTANCE CENTRAL FOCUS [1] THOREAU'S TAX REFUSAL ILLUSTRATES CONSCIENCE AGAINST PARTICIPATION IN [2] GANDHI'S SALT-LAW DEFIANCE ILLUSTRATES PUBLIC AND NON-VIOLENT CIVIL [3] Kelsen's GRUNDNORM AND DWORKIN'S INHERITANCE PRINCIPLE ARE JURISPRUDENTIAL [4] TRAFFIC REGULATION ILLUSTRATES CLARITY AND RELEVANT DIFFERENTIATION UNDER NAMED EXAMPLES EARN MARKS ONLY WHEN THEIR CONCEPTUAL ROLE ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Named Evidence for Obligation, Law and Resistance
- [1] Thoreau's tax refusal illustrates conscience against participation in injustice.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Gandhi's salt-law defiance illustrates public and non-violent civil disobedience.
- [3] Kelsen's Grundnorm and Dworkin's inheritance principle are jurisprudential evidence.
- [4] Traffic regulation illustrates clarity and relevant differentiation under rule of law.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Named examples earn marks only when their conceptual role is explicit.
- ANSWER USE → Pair every event or text with one distinction and one boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Named examples earn marks only when their conceptual role is explicit.

08

STAGE 08 CLAIM-EVIDENCE-LIMIT AND MARK-SCALED ANSWERS

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-LIMIT AND MARK-SCALED ANSWERS CENTRAL FOCUS [1] A 10-MARKER NEEDS ONE DISTINCTION, ONE THINKER AND [2] A 15-MARKER COMPARES GROUNDS OR RUNS ONE OBJECTION [3] A 20-MARKER INTEGRATES VALIDITY, LEGITIMACY, RESISTANCE AND RULE [4] EVERY CONCLUSION MUST SPECIFY THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH MARK-SCALED STRUCTURE PREVENTS BOTH SLOGAN AND UNCONTROLLED NARRATION. ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Claim-Evidence-Limit and Mark-Scaled Answers
- [1] A 10-marker needs one distinction, one thinker and a direct verdict.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] A 15-marker compares grounds or runs one objection and reply.
- [3] A 20-marker integrates validity, legitimacy, resistance and rule of law.
- [4] Every conclusion must specify the conditions under which obedience remains justified.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Mark-scaled structure prevents both slogan and uncontrolled narration.
- ANSWER USE → Expand from one distinction to an objection-reply architecture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Mark-scaled structure prevents both slogan and uncontrolled narration.

09

STAGE 09 CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION AND FINAL INTEGRATION

CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION AND FINAL INTEGRATION CENTRAL FOCUS [1] THE MARCH 2026 TELE-LAW CONSULTATION IS AN ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE [2] ACCESSIBLE LEGAL ADVICE CAN MAKE REMEDIES AND COMPLIANCE [3] SERVICE EXPANSION CANNOT PROVE THAT EVERY ENACTED RULE [4] USE THE EXAMPLE FOR LEGITIMACY AND RULE-OF-LAW ACCESS ACCESS TO LEGAL ADVICE CAN SUPPORT LEGITIMACY WITHOUT PROVING ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS

Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration

[1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor.

[2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful.

[3] Service expansion cannot prove that every enacted rule or official act is just.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration
- [1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful.
- [3] Service expansion cannot prove that every enacted rule or official act is just.
- [4] Use the example for legitimacy and rule-of-law access, not unverified legal detail.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Access to legal advice can support legitimacy without proving justice.
- ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

CENTRAL FOCUS

Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration

[1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor.

[2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful.

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CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration
- [1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful.
- [3] Service expansion cannot prove that every enacted rule or official act is just.
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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Access to legal advice can support legitimacy without proving justice.
- ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

10

STAGE 10

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] CLOSE OPTIONS TEST FORCE VERSUS DUTY AND VALIDITY

[2] THEY ALSO TEST RESISTANCE VERSUS REVOLUTION AND OBJECTION

[3] AUSTIN, KELSEN AND HART REMAIN DISTINCT FROM DWORKIN'S

[4] PUNISHMENT THEORIES ANSWER DESERT, PREVENTION AND REFORM QUESTIONS

CLOSE OPTIONS ARE SEPARATED BY TARGET, METHOD AND JUSTIFICATORY

ANSWER USE

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] Close options test force versus duty and validity versus legitimacy.

[2] They also test resistance versus revolution and objection versus civil disobedience.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair
- [1] Close options test force versus duty and validity versus legitimacy.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] They also test resistance versus revolution and objection versus civil disobedience.
- [3] Austin, Kelsen and Hart remain distinct from Dworkin's interpretivist challenge.
- [4] Punishment theories answer desert, prevention and reform questions separately.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Close options are separated by target, method and justificatory basis.
- ANSWER USE → Identify the decisive distinction before eliminating an option.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Close options are separated by target, method and justificatory basis.

11

STAGE 11

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] FOUR PUNISHMENT PYQS ARE TRANSFERRED ONLY FOR CROSS-APPLICATION.

[2] PRIMARY OWNERSHIP REMAINS PHILOSOPHY PAPER II - CRIME

[3] SIX ORIGINAL QUESTIONS TEST OBLIGATION, RESISTANCE, JURISPRUDENCE AND

[4] FINAL RECALL

VALID LAW EARNS DUTY ONLY THROUGH LEGITIMACY AND NON-ARBITRARY

CROSS-APPLIED PYQS RETAIN THEIR CRIME AND PUNISHMENT OWNERSHIP.

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] Four punishment PYQs are transferred only for cross-application.

[2] Primary ownership remains Philosophy Paper II - Crime and Punishment.

[3] Six original questions test obligation, resistance, jurisprudence and rule of law.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice
- [1] Four punishment PYQs are transferred only for cross-application.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Primary ownership remains Philosophy Paper II - Crime and Punishment.
- [3] Six original questions test obligation, resistance, jurisprudence and rule of law.
- [4] Final recall: valid law earns duty only through legitimacy and non-arbitrary rule.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Cross-applied PYQs retain their Crime and Punishment ownership.
- ANSWER USE → Cite ownership, then apply only the relevant Political Theory lens.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Cross-applied PYQs retain their Crime and Punishment ownership.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. ONE-SCREEN ADVANCED MAP

2. SCOPE, ASSUMPTIONS AND CONCEPTUAL BOUNDARY

3. DIRECT-BOOK ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION

4. DEFINITIONS AND DISTINCTIONS

5. THINKER-BY-THINKER POSITIONS

6. COMPETING PERSPECTIVES

7. INTERNAL DEBATES AND CRITICISMS

OPTIONAL THEORY DEPTH

- 1. One-screen advanced map
- 2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary
- 3. Direct-book argument reconstruction
- 4. Definitions and distinctions

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- 5. Thinker-by-thinker positions
- 6. Competing perspectives
- 7. Internal debates and criticisms
- 8. Comparative matrix

COMPARATIVE / INSTITUTIONAL NUANCE

- 9. Application without current-affairs dependence
- 10. UPSC answer-engine prompts
- 11. Cross-links and exclusions
- 12. Factual-risk checks

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

POLITICAL OBLIGATION, RESISTANCE AND LAW • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 8132-11366 of 11366 • end